

# CIVICS AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

## Lecture#1

### 1. Concept and Definition of Civics

The word 'Civics' itself is the combination of two words, 'Civis' and 'Civitas', taken from Latin language speaking of 'city' and 'citizens' respectively. Civics is the study of the rights and duties of citizens and the functioning of government.

**Citizen** is the person who may be obedient to state, may have awareness and to whom state provides social, economic and political rights who has the passion of following the constitutions and serving his country as well.

It encompasses the understanding of political systems, structures, rights, and the responsibilities of citizens. The goal of civics is to equip individuals with the knowledge to participate effectively in public life, including voting, understanding laws, and advocating for community needs.

#### . Key Components of Civics:

- Government Structure: Learning about branches of government (executive, legislative, judicial) and their functions.
- Rights and Responsibilities: Understanding fundamental rights (such as freedom of speech, right to vote) and responsibilities (like obeying laws, paying taxes).
- Rule of Law: Awareness of the laws and how they maintain order and protect citizens' rights.
- Public Participation: Encouraging individuals to participate in the civic process (e.g., voting, public service).

**Dr. Aziz Ahmad:** Civics is the study of individuals and institute whose individuals either are the members by birth or they become its members by choice.

**Oxford Dictionary:** The study of rights and duties of citizenship is called civics.

Civics plays important role in modern social studies. The role of citizens in social, democratic and political life is of much significance these days. If they play their part well, it can bring them proficient outcomes.

### 2. Concept and Definition of Citizenship

Citizenship is a legal status given by a country to an individual, conferring rights and responsibilities. It involves a sense of belonging and identity within a particular nation, along with specific rights (e.g., voting, freedom of speech) and duties (e.g., obeying laws, paying taxes). There are different ways to acquire citizenship, including birth, naturalization, and marriage.

It connects people legally, socially, and emotionally to a country, enabling them to participate fully in its political and social life. Citizenship typically involves allegiance to a country, compliance with its laws, and an understanding of civic duties.

## Types of Rights in Citizenship:

- Civil Rights: Right to equality and freedom from discrimination.
- Political Rights: Right to participate in political life, including voting and running for office.
- Social Rights: Access to welfare, healthcare, and education.

**Example:** In Pakistan, citizens aged 18 and above have the right to vote in elections, which gives them a voice in the democratic process. However, they also have the responsibility to follow the country's laws and contribute to its betterment. During recent elections, many young people registered to vote for the first time, showing an active exercise of their citizenship.

## 1. Concept and Definition of Civic Engagement

Civic engagement refers to the active participation of individuals in activities that address public issues, improve institutions, and contribute to governance including voting, community service, volunteering, or advocacy. It emphasizes actions taken to promote the quality of life in a community, through political and non-political processes. Civic engagement fosters social cohesion, accountability in governance, and community resilience.

Civic engagement is the foundation of democracy, as it enables citizens to voice their opinions, advocate for change, and influence government actions. By promoting civic engagement, societies can build stronger, more inclusive communities where citizens work together to address shared challenges and enhance the well-being of all members.

### Forms of Civic Engagement:

- Voting: A fundamental civic duty and the most common form of participation.
- Community Service: Volunteering or working to improve community resources, welfare, or services.
- Activism: Participating in campaigns, protests, and initiatives aimed at social or political change.
- Public Discourse: Engaging in discussions or debates to share views and promote dialogue.

**Example:** In 2022, after severe floods in Pakistan, many local communities rallied together to support affected families. Volunteer groups collected donations, distributed food, and provided shelter to displaced individuals. This shows how community engagement plays a crucial role during crises, helping society recover faster and support each other.

To Conclude that, Civics provides us with the knowledge about our rights and government functions and Citizenship is the legal status and identity given by a country to an individual, conferring rights and responsibilities while community engagement gives us the platform to apply this knowledge practically. For example, understanding how local councils work enables people to participate in town

meetings, voice concerns, or even initiate petitions to address issues like road repairs, public safety, or waste management in their area.

### 3. Difference Between Community and Society

- **Community:** A community is a smaller, more localized group of people who often share common interests, values, or goals. They usually have close, informal and direct relationships, face to face interactions.
- **Society:** Society is a broader, more complex organization of individuals who may not share a close, personal bond and formal relationships. It encompasses various communities and institutions, organized under a larger framework with a shared culture, norms, and institutions.

Example :The residents of a village represent a **community**, where people know each other and interact frequently. The entire population of Pakistan represents a **society**, which includes many diverse communities united under shared national laws, culture, and government.

| Feature       | Community                                  | Society                                 |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Scale         | Smaller, localized                         | Larger, encompassing many communities   |
| Relationships | Personal,direct,informal                   | Impersonal,indirect, formal             |
| Diversity     | Less diverse, often shared characteristics | Highly diverse                          |
| Purpose       | Support,belonging,shared goals             | Order,stability,large-scale cooperation |
| Organization  | Informal structure                         | Formal institutions and rules           |

In essence, communities exist within societies, each playing an essential role: communities provide support and identity, while society offers the broader framework that unites and organizes these communities.

## Lecture#2

### Types of Citizenship: Active, Participatory, Digital ,Global etc.

Citizenship refers to the legal status, rights, and responsibilities individuals have as members of a state or society. Over time, the concept of citizenship has evolved, with different types emerging to reflect new social, political, and technological realities. There are following types of citizenship.

#### 1.Active Citizenship

Active citizenship refers to individuals who take an active role in their communities and democratic processes. Active citizens go beyond just following laws and voting; they take part in improving society through volunteerism, activism, and engagement with local or national issues. Active citizens focus on building community, creating change, and ensuring accountability in governance.

##### Characteristics of Active Citizenship:

- Advocacy: Actively promoting causes or addressing social issues.
- Involvement: Participating in civic and political activities like town hall meetings, public discussions, and advocacy groups.
- Volunteerism: Contributing time and resources to support public good or community needs.

**Example:** In Lahore, a group of citizens initiates a “Clean Green Lahore” project, organizing weekly clean-up drives in public parks and neighborhoods. They also educate others on reducing waste, recycling, and protecting public spaces, encouraging active involvement in their local environment.

#### 2.Participatory Citizenship

Participatory citizenship emphasizes direct involvement in the decision-making processes that affect communities and society. This type of citizenship promotes collective engagement and interaction with governance processes to create more representative and inclusive policies.

Participatory citizenship is highly valued in democracies as it strengthens community bonds and ensures diverse perspectives in decision-making.

##### Components of Participatory Citizenship:

- Public Consultations: Citizens contribute to government decision-making by sharing views on policies, plans, or development projects.
- Community Boards: Participating in local councils, boards, or committees to make decisions that affect community welfare.
- Collaborative Platforms: Using platforms (e.g., online forums, town halls) for collaborative discussions on community issues.

**Example:** In Karachi, residents gather at a local town hall meeting to discuss water shortages. They voice their concerns, propose solutions, and sign petitions, urging the government to invest in better water infrastructure. This participatory approach empowers citizens to influence policies that directly affect their lives.



### 3.Digital Citizenship

Digital citizenship involves using digital technology responsibly and effectively to engage in society, politics, and community issues. Digital citizens use the internet, social media, and other digital tools to communicate, advocate, and participate in civic activities. In the digital age, responsible online behavior, understanding cyber ethics, and promoting positive digital interactions are vital parts of citizenship.

#### **Key Aspects of Digital Citizenship:**

- **Cybersecurity Awareness:** Understanding privacy, security, and the responsible use of personal data online.
- **Digital Literacy:** The ability to evaluate information sources critically and avoid misinformation.
- **Online Civic Participation:** Engaging in petitions, advocacy campaigns, and social media discussions that promote societal change.

**Example:** A group of young people in Pakistan creates an online campaign to promote mental health awareness on social media. They share helpful resources, debunk myths, and encourage respectful discussions on mental well-being. Practicing digital citizenship, they use the platform responsibly and ensure information accuracy, promoting a safe online community.

### 4.Global Citizenship

Global citizenship extends beyond national citizenship to encompass a sense of belonging to a global community. It encourages individuals to recognize their role in addressing global issues, including climate change, poverty, environmental sustainability, social justice, and human rights. Global citizens support initiatives and policies that benefit humanity as a whole.

#### **Components of Global Citizenship:**

- **Awareness of Global Issues:** Understanding issues like environmental sustainability, inequality, and international cooperation.
- **Intercultural Competence:** Respecting cultural diversity and promoting inclusivity.
- **Ethical Responsibility:** Acting in ways that contribute positively to global well-being, such as supporting fair trade or reducing environmental impact.

**Example:** Pakistani students participating in an international campaign to address climate change. They connect with people from different countries to exchange ideas, sign petitions for global environmental policies, and promote sustainable practices in their own communities. Or Raising voice for palestine advocating for the rights and freedoms of Palestinians. They participate in campaigns, rallies, and online activism, calling for justice, peace, and an end to violence in the region.

### 5.Ecological Citizenship (Green Citizenship)

Ecological or green citizenship focus on the belief that individuals have responsibilities toward the environment and should engage in activities that promote environmental sustainability and conservation. It encourages citizens to take part in sustainable practices, advocate for environmental policies, and promote awareness on

issues like climate change and conservation. Environmental citizenship extends beyond local communities, often addressing global environmental issues.

**Example:** In Karachi, citizens participate in a "Plastic-Free Karachi" campaign, avoiding single-use plastics and promoting recycling. They encourage local businesses to adopt biodegradable packaging and educate the community on the impact of plastic waste on marine life in the Arabian Sea.

## 6.Economic Citizenship

Economic citizenship refers to the rights, responsibilities, and active participation of individuals in the economic life of their community and country. It encompasses the ability to engage in economic activities, such as working, owning property, and participating in the market, as well as responsibilities like paying taxes and contributing to economic development. Economic citizenship also involves understanding economic systems, advocating for fair economic policies, and promoting financial literacy.

**Example:** A person working in a factory in Lahore contributes to the economy by producing goods, earning a salary, and paying taxes. Their work supports economic growth and helps fund public services.

## 7.Cultural Citizenship

Cultural citizenship is about the right of people to take part in and contribute to the cultural life of their community and society. It means recognizing and protecting different cultural identities, languages, and traditions. It also emphasizes that being a part of a community isn't just about legal status, but also about feeling culturally connected and included.

**Example:** In a multicultural city like Karachi, different communities celebrate their festivals, such as Eid, Christmas, Diwali,, contributing to a rich cultural tapestry. The recognition and public celebration of these festivals foster a sense of belonging and respect for cultural diversity.

## 8.Social Citizenship

Social citizenship refers to the rights and responsibilities individuals have to ensure social welfare and equality in society. It involves access to social services like education, healthcare, housing, and social security. Social citizenship emphasizes the importance of social justice, inclusion, and the collective well-being of all members of society.

### Importance of Social Citizenship:

- **Promotes Social Cohesion:** By ensuring everyone has access to basic needs, social citizenship helps build a more unified and supportive community.
- **Reduces Inequality:** Access to social services and opportunities helps bridge the gap between different social and economic groups.

- **Enhances Quality of Life:** Social rights improve the overall well-being and security of individuals, leading to a healthier and more productive society.
- **Encourages Active Participation:** When people feel supported, they are more likely to contribute positively to their community and society.

## 9. Corporate Citizenship

Corporate citizenship refers to the social responsibilities and ethical obligations that businesses have towards society. It involves how companies manage their operations to have a positive impact on society, the environment, and the economy. Corporate citizenship goes beyond profit-making to include the company's contributions to community welfare, environmental sustainability, and ethical business practices.

**Example:** A company that uses eco-friendly materials in its products and donates to local charities. Supporting education initiatives by partnering with schools to provide resources or mentoring.

## 10. Digital Natives and Networked Citizenship

Networked citizenship is a part of digital citizenship that describes the younger generation, often known as digital natives, who are very familiar with technology. They use digital tools to connect with others and engage in important global issues in new and unique ways.

**Examples:** People using Twitter, Instagram, or TikTok to support movements like Black Lives Matter, sharing information and organizing protests. Organizing fundraising events through platforms like GoFundMe to support causes they care about.



## Lecture#3

### The Relationship Between Democracy and Citizenship

The relationship between democracy and citizenship is fundamental and deeply interconnected, as each concept relies on and reinforces the other. Democracy is a form of government where people have the power to make decisions, either directly or by choosing representatives through elections. Citizenship, meanwhile, is about being part of a political community (usually a country), with certain rights and responsibilities. There are the following at how democracy and citizenship are connected:

**1. Democracy as a System of Governance:** In a democracy, people have the power, either directly or through elected leaders. This system is based on the idea that government authority comes from the people. Elections allow citizens to choose their leaders, who must follow the law and are accountable to the people. Democracy relies on citizens actively participating to ensure fair representation.

**2. Citizenship as Legal and Social Status:** Citizenship means being legally recognized by a state, with certain rights and responsibilities. It involves not only following the law but also contributing to society, such as through community service or public discussions. In a democratic society, citizenship balances rights and responsibilities.

**3. Democratic Citizenship and Political Participation:** Democratic citizenship involves more than voting; it means staying informed, discussing issues, and participating in community decisions. This participation keeps democratic institutions responsive and accountable. When citizens are disengaged, democracy weakens, as there's less accountability.

**4. Protecting Rights in a Democracy:** Democracy is committed to protecting citizens' rights, allowing them to express opinions, engage in civil society, and challenge unfair policies. The government in a democracy must respect these rights equally for all citizens, building trust and encouraging civic engagement.

**5. Education and Democratic Citizenship:** For democracy to function well, citizens need to understand how government works and their rights and responsibilities. Civic education helps prepare citizens to participate effectively, make informed voting choices, and engage in public debate. Without civic knowledge, people may be misled, weakening democracy.

**6. Balancing Rights and Responsibilities:** In a democracy, citizenship involves a give-and-take relationship. The government provides rights that protect citizens, and citizens, in return, participate by voting, following laws, and respecting others' rights. A strong sense of civic duty helps maintain a healthy democracy.

**7. Civic Engagement and Strengthening Democracy:** Democratic citizenship goes beyond voting. Being engaged in civil society by joining community service,



advocacy groups, or civic organizations strengthens social trust and cooperation. This active involvement ensures democracy meets community needs.

**8.Challenges to Democratic Citizenship:** When citizens don't participate fully, democracy faces challenges. Political apathy (feeling disconnected from politics) weakens accountability. Social and economic inequalities can lead to unequal participation, with marginalized groups having less influence. Globalization also complicates citizenship, as people increasingly move across borders and may not fully engage in one country's democratic process.

**9. Global Citizenship and Democracy:** In a globalized world, people increasingly see themselves as global citizens, responsible for upholding human rights, protecting the environment, and promoting social justice worldwide. This broad view of citizenship challenges the traditional idea of belonging to a single nation-state, especially as migrants and refugees navigate different rights and responsibilities across borders.

**Conclusion:** The relationship between democracy and citizenship is crucial for democratic societies. Citizenship in a democracy isn't passive; it's an active role in shaping governance and community life. Active, informed, and engaged citizens are essential for democracy to work effectively, ensuring the government represents the people's will and upholds democratic values like equality, justice, and rights protection. For democracy to succeed, citizenship should be inclusive, participatory, and balanced in rights and responsibilities. As modern challenges evolve, so does the role of citizenship, but its purpose remains the same: empowering people to participate in and shape their political communities.